

FILE : T08_AI_Trades_2026-10-01_1649.md
CREATED : 2026-10-01_1649 UTC
PURPOSE : Teacher lesson plan for "AI for Contractors and the Trades" (industry track).
READ FIRST: 00_IEBC_Teaching_Playbook_2026-10-01_1649.md
PDF GENERATED : 2026-10-01_1702 UTC

T08 Teacher Guide: AI for Contractors and the Trades

Format	Self-paced video + monthly live Q&A
Length	5 modules, about 4 hours of student time (about 60 minutes of video)
Level	Beginner
Demo business	Ridgeline Builders (3-person remodeling crew)
Student deliverable	Estimate template, job tracker and job-to-invoice workflow

Teaching notes

- Students work from trucks and job sites. **Demo everything on a phone too.** If it only works on a laptop, they won't use it.
- Keep videos short and practical. Many students will watch at lunch on site.
- ★ Pricing stays with the contractor. AI writes and formats; it doesn't set prices or calculate materials without the contractor checking every number.

Course-level objectives

Students can produce a professional estimate in minutes, track jobs with photos from the phone, take bookings with reminders, invoice on job completion and keep 1099 records.

Module 1: Estimates and proposals with AI (3 videos, ~15 min)

★ MUST TEACH:

1. Estimate template: scope, line items, exclusions, timeline, terms, signature.
2. Voice-to-estimate: record job notes on the phone → AI turns them into a scope of work.
3. ★ Mistake moment: AI adds work the contractor never mentioned ("includes permit fees") or does math wrong. Check every line and every total.
4. Exclusions protect you: ask AI to suggest exclusions, then keep only the true ones.

SHOW: Ridgeline bathroom remodel: 90-second voice note → scope → estimate PDF. **Assignment 1:** Estimate template + one sample estimate from a real (or recent) job.

Not yet	Meets	Strong
Missing exclusions/terms or math errors	Complete template, correct totals	Also an e-signature step and deposit terms

Module 2: Jobs from your phone (2 videos, ~12 min)

★ MUST TEACH: job tracker (status, address, customer, photos, notes), before/during/after photo routine, materials and supply cost log per job, and getting photos off the camera roll and into the job record.

Module 3: Booking and customer follow-up (2 videos, ~10 min)

★ MUST TEACH: online booking for estimates, appointment reminders, "on my way" texts, and review requests after completion (T02 pattern, trades examples).

Module 4: Invoices and payments (2 videos, ~10 min)

★ MUST TEACH: invoice from the estimate when the job is marked complete, deposits and progress billing, payment reminders (friendly → firm → call).

Module 5: Taxes and 1099 records (2 videos, ~10 min)

★ MUST TEACH: track expenses per job, W-9 before paying subs, keep sub payments recorded. Disclaimer: tax decisions belong with a tax professional.

Assignment 2 (final): Job-to-invoice workflow working end to end on one real or test job.

Not yet	Meets	Strong
Steps still manual or untested	Estimate → job → invoice flows with photos attached	Also review request and payment reminders on

Live Q&A focus

"Estimate clinic": students share (redacted) estimates; teacher improves scope wording and exclusions live.